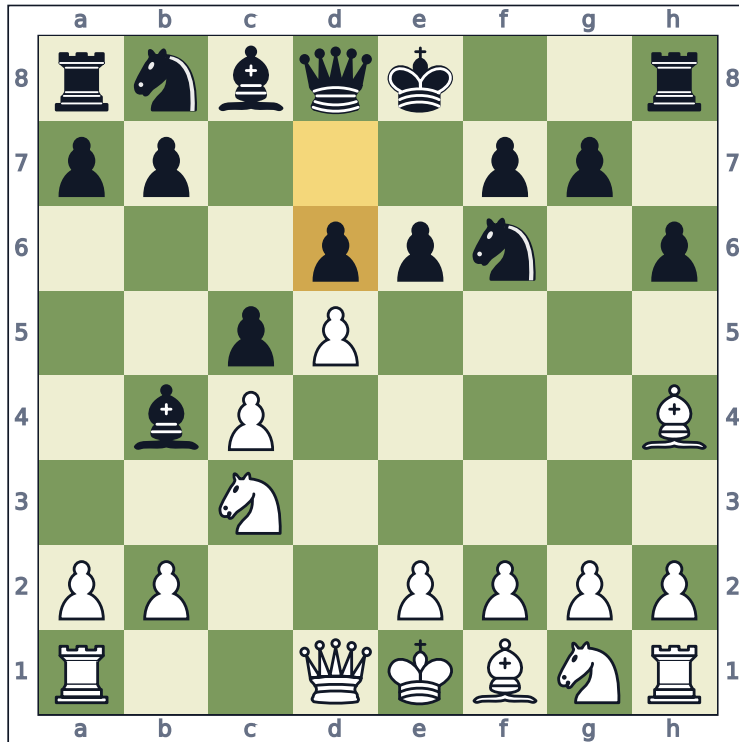


NIMZO-INDIAN DEFENSE

Nimzo-Indian Defense

ECO E31 | 1 named line in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has already conceded the easier game and must know the compensation or plan.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

-0.43 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

E31 covers Nimzo-Indian Defense. Black pins the c3 knight and fights for e4, often exchanging a bishop for structural control or rapid development. The diagram uses the featured line Nimzo-Indian Defense: Leningrad Variation, Benoni Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bg5 h6 5. Bh4 c5 6. d5 d6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the bishop pair and central space, manage doubled pawns constructively, and decide whether e4 or a queenside advance is realistic.

BLACK'S GOALS

Pressure c4/e4, exploit weak squares, and choose the right moment to surrender or preserve the dark-squared bishop.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black uses ...c5, ...d5, or ...e5; White often seeks e4, d5, or queenside expansion with a3 and b4.

PIECE MAP

The c3 knight, e4 square, and bishop-pair decision are the strategic core. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Doubled pawns are not automatically weak: activity, open files, and central control may compensate fully. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d5, Black pawn on d6, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of Black's very best defenses to 1.d4, rich enough for a lifetime of study.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named E31 line

This section preserves all 1 names and defining routes assigned to E31 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Nimzo-Indian Defense: Leningrad Variation, Benoni Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bg5 h6 5. Bh4 c5 6. d5 d6